

June 1, 2026



Biobank Working Group

Agenda

- 12:00–12:05 Updates
 - Letter of intent
- 12:05–1:20 Issues ranking and discussion
- 1:20–1:30 Goals presentation



Issues

Vision

Goals

Objectives

Actions

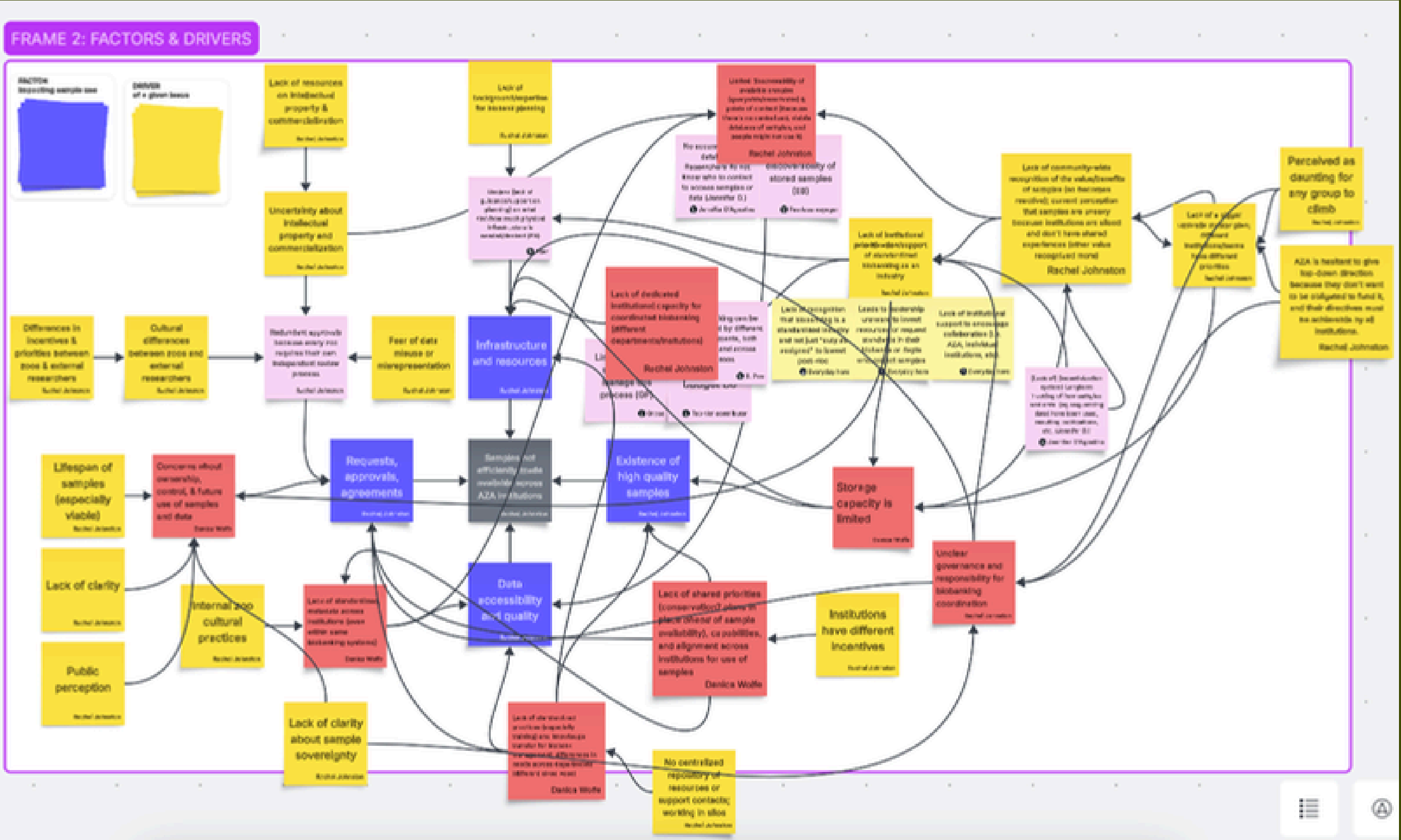




Vision

By 2055, biological specimens and associated data from biodiversity institutions are mobilized seamlessly at scale—driving discovery, strengthening resilient populations, and safeguarding species through fully integrated *ex situ* and *in situ* conservation and research.

Issues



Issues

Pre-sampling: Institutional coordination, governance, & trust

1. Unclear governance and responsibility for coordinated biobanking
2. Lack of shared priorities, capabilities, and alignment across institutions for sample use
3. Concerns about ownership, control, and future use of samples and data
4. Limited tracking and recognition of sample/data use and downstream outcomes

During sampling: Operations & infrastructure

5. Lack of guidance and support for institutional biobanking infrastructure planning
6. Limited dedicated institutional capacity for coordinated biobanking
7. Lack of standardized practices, training, and knowledge transfer for biobank management
8. Limited biobank storage capacity

Post-sampling: Access & use

9. Limited discoverability of available samples, associated data, and institutional points of contact
10. Redundant institutional approval processes for sample and data access
11. Lack of standardized metadata across institutions and biobanking systems

Issues Criteria



Severity: To what extent does this issue affect access to samples and associated data across institutions and for those seeking to use them?

- 3 (High): Affects a large majority (>67%) of efforts involving sample access and use; frequently blocks or significantly limits access for users
- 2 (Medium): Affects a substantial portion (~33–67%) of efforts involving sample access and use; slows or complicates access for users in many cases
- 1 (Low): Affects a minority (<33%) of efforts involving sample access and use; causes only minor or occasional barriers to access for users

Leverage: To what extent would addressing this issue create broader progress toward large-scale, seamless mobilization and use of samples and associated data across the AZA community?

- 3 (High): Would substantially enable or accelerate progress toward large-scale mobilization and use of samples across institutions, including by reducing major system-wide barriers or enabling multiple downstream improvements
- 2 (Medium): Would support meaningful progress in some areas of large-scale mobilization of samples, but with more limited system-wide effect
- 1 (Low): Would improve a relatively isolated issue or have limited broader effect on large-scale mobilization and use of samples and associated data

Feasibility: How feasible is it for us to address this issue within current institutional and resource constraints?

- 3 (High): Readily addressable with existing structures or modest changes
- 2 (Medium): Possible but requires coordination or significant effort
- 1 (Low): Very difficult to address under current constraints

Scoring time!

ISSUE SCORING INSTRUCTIONS:

For each issue, place one score for that issue's **severity**, **leverage**, and **feasibility** (i.e. for each issue, one score on severity, one score on leverage, and one score on feasibility)
Place your score by hovering over your selection and pressing the plus (+) button

PRE-SAMPLING	DURING SAMPLING	POST SAMPLING	
Issue: Unclear governance and responsibility for a coordinated data strategy SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	Issue: Lack of guidance and support for institutional data strategy SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	Issue: Lack of shared principles, capabilities, and alignment across institutions for sample use SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	
Issue: Lack of shared principles, capabilities, and alignment across institutions for sample use SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	Issue: Limited data levels of institutional capacity for coordinated data strategy SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	Issue: Limited discoverability of available samples, associated data, and information points of contact SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	
Issue: Concerns about ownership, control, and future use of samples and data SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	Issue: Lack of standardized practices, training, & monitoring for data for institutional data strategy SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	Issue: Limited discoverability of available samples, associated data, and information points of contact SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	
Issue: Limited tracking and recognition of sample/data use across institutions SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3	Issue: Limited data levels of institutional capacity for coordinated data strategy SEVERITY: 1 2 3 LEVERAGE: 1 2 3 FEASIBILITY: 1 2 3		

SCORING CRITERIA

Severity

To what extent does this issue affect access to samples and associated data across institutions and for those seeking to use them?

- 3 (High): Affects a large majority (>87%) of efforts involving sample access and use; frequently blocks or significantly limits access for users
- 2 (Medium): Affects a substantial portion (~33-87%) of efforts involving sample access and use; slows or complicates access for users in many cases
- 1 (Low): Affects a minority (<33%) of efforts involving sample access and use; causes only minor or occasional barriers to access for users

Leverage

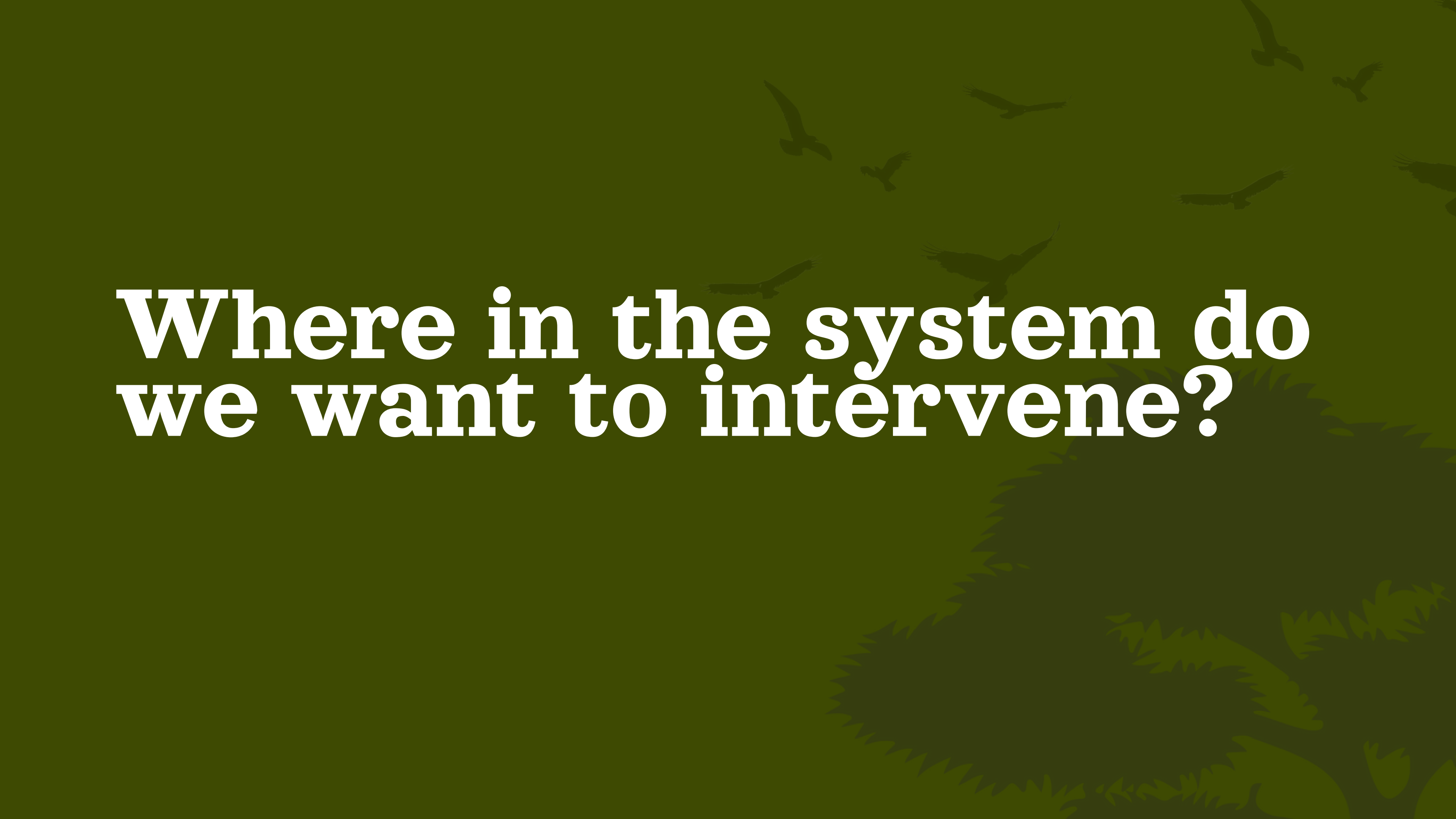
To what extent would addressing this issue create or accelerate progress toward large-scale, sustainable mobilization and use of samples and associated data across the AZA community?

- 3 (High): Would substantially enable or accelerate progress toward large-scale mobilization and use of samples across institutions, including by reducing major system-wide barriers or resolving multiple downstream impediments
- 2 (Medium): Would support meaningful progress in some areas of large-scale mobilization of samples, but with more limited system-wide effect
- 1 (Low): Would improve a relatively isolated issue or have limited broader effect on large-scale mobilization and use of samples and associated data

Feasibility

How feasible is it for us to address this issue within current institutional and resource constraints?

- 3 (High): Easily addressable with existing structures or modest changes
- 2 (Medium): Possible but requires coordination or significant effort
- 1 (Low): Very difficult to address under current constraints

The background of the slide features a stylized, dark green illustration of a forest landscape. In the foreground, there are silhouettes of various trees and bushes. The sky is filled with several birds in flight, depicted as simple dark shapes with outstretched wings. The overall color palette is monochromatic, using different shades of green.

**Where in the system do
we want to intervene?**

Goals

Goals: the **conditions** (what) you ultimately want to achieve (not how!)

- Includes the desired condition & the reason why the change would help
- Goals are future conditions, not solutions
- Goals are not databases, policies, forms, committees, software
- Goals should instead sound like:
 - “Institutions can...”
 - “Samples and data are...”
 - “Participation is...”
 - “Users can access...”



Vision



Goals



Objectives



Actions

By 2055, biological specimens and associated data from biodiversity institutions are mobilized seamlessly at scale—driving discovery, strengthening resilient populations, and safeguarding species through fully integrated *ex situ* and *in situ* conservation and research.

To accelerate discovery and strengthen population management, biospecimens and associated data across participating AZA institutions are as discoverable, interoperable, and accessible as if they originated from a single institution.

Objective (2 yr): By 2028, 10 institutions have a designated biobank contact and ≥ 50 samples publicly discoverable.

Objective (5 yr): By 2031, participating institutions adopt a shared minimum metadata standard that enables biospecimens & associated data to be searched and interpreted consistently across institutions.

Objective (10 yr): By 2036, clear, standardized processes for sharing samples across network institutions are implemented, reducing administrative barriers while maintaining trust and appropriate oversight.

Wrap-up

- **Homework**

- Sign letter of intent this week (by **June 5**)
- Share 1–2 broad strategic goals (the earlier the better; by **June 26**)

- Next meeting: Monday July 6



GOALS

Please add 1-2 draft goal ideas to this document by **Friday June 26**. Please include your name when adding goals to help facilitate discussion; goals will be synthesized and refined collectively. Goals should describe future conditions we want to achieve, rather than specific actions or solutions. A strong goal:

- Describes a desired future condition.
- Explains why achieving that condition would matter.
- Is broad enough to encompass multiple objectives and actions.
- Is aspirational but grounded in the realities of participating institutions.

Don't worry about writing the perfect goal. We're looking for raw material to synthesize and refine together. It's completely fine if goals overlap or build on one another. Similar ideas can help reveal areas of convergence. Feel free to add comments on, or expand, existing ideas in addition to adding your own.

Example goal: To accelerate discovery and strengthen population management, biospecimens and associated data across participating AZA institutions are as discoverable, interoperable, and accessible as if they originated from a single institution. -Rachel Johnston